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Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-074-24/25, **Version:** 1

Project Approval for the Washington Irving Middle School Math Music Engineering Magnet Major Modernization Project

January 14, 2025

Facilities Services Division

Action Proposed:

Approve the proposed Washington Irving Middle School Math Music Engineering Magnet Major Modernization Project (Project).

Authorize the Chief Procurement Officer and/or the Chief Facilities Executive and/or their designee(s) to execute all reasonable instruments to implement the proposed Project, including budget modifications and the purchase of equipment and materials.

The Office of Environmental Health and Safety's (OEHS) evaluation of the proposed Project resulted in the preparation of an Environmental Impact Report (EIR). Pursuant to the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) Guidelines, staff is requesting the Board of Education (Board) approve the proposed Project so that construction activities can commence at a later date. The proposed action may only be considered after the Board certifies the EIR prepared by OEHS in compliance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines for the proposed Project.

Background:

On October 12, 2021, the Board approved the project definition for site due diligence, planning, and feasibility activities necessary to propose scope recommendations, budget, and schedule for the proposed Project. Subsequently, on November 15, 2022, the Board approved the project redefinition for the proposed Project to begin the environmental review, design, procurement, and other activities necessary to implement the proposed Project.

The proposed Project is located within the 11.18-acre school campus at 3010 Estara Avenue within the Glassell Park/Los Feliz neighborhood in the City of Los Angeles (Board District 5, Region West). Irving STEAM Magnet Middle School (School) opened in 1937. All existing buildings were constructed between 1937 and 2004. The campus has been identified eligible as a historic district due to its depiction of a post-Long Beach Earthquake middle school campus that embodies Los Angeles Unified school planning and design concepts of the period and is an example of PWA (Public Works Administration) Moderne architecture applied to a middle school campus. The Administration Building, one-story Classroom Building, Homemaking Building and five relocatable buildings are identified as being located on an earthquake fault. As of the 2024-2025 Electronic Capacity Assessment Review (E-CAR), the School served approximately 900 students in grades 6 through 8 and the projected enrollment for planning purposes is 750 students.

The proposed Project will construct new facilities, including a two-story Classroom Building with 19 general and specialty classrooms and support spaces, library, student store and administration spaces; a one-story Maintenance & Operations Building with office and support spaces; and a one-story City of Angels Building

with 2 general classrooms and support spaces. The proposed Project also includes the seismic retrofit of the existing Auditorium and infrastructure upgrades to ensure compliance with the Americans with Disabilities Act. The proposed Project will reduce the School's current capacity and total number of classrooms from 65 to 46 classrooms based on the planned/projected enrollment.

The proposed Project includes the demolition of three permanent buildings (two-story Administration Building, one-story Classroom Building and one-story Homemaking Building), and six relocatable buildings. Interim facilities will be installed to allow the School to remain operational and minimize impact during construction.

The proposed Project also includes utility upgrades; a campus-wide fire alarm upgrade; Internet Protocol (IP) convergence; new parking areas; new outdoor learning environments; the removal and replacement of trees; landscaping and irrigation; hardscaping; fencing, gates, and site furnishings.

Expected Outcomes:

Approval of the proposed Project will permit construction activities to be undertaken once the Division of the State Architect (DSA) approval is secured. Construction activities related to the construction of new buildings are anticipated to begin in the third quarter of 2026, and site/utility/interim facilities activities may begin in advance of this work, in an earlier phase. Construction is anticipated to be completed in the first quarter of 2030.

Board Options and Consequences:

Adoption of staff's proposal will permit Los Angeles Unified to proceed with the construction of the proposed Project after DSA approval is secured. If the proposed action is not adopted, staff will be unable to proceed with construction activities. As a result, the School will continue to operate with aging, deteriorating, and outdated buildings and grounds and will continue to have students in buildings located on an earthquake fault. Furthermore, students, staff and the community will not benefit from the significant facilities improvements that will be undertaken as part of the proposed Project.

Policy Implications:

This action helps facilitate the Facilities Services Division Strategic Execution Plan and supports the goals and objectives of the School Upgrade Program (SUP). The proposed action advances Los Angeles Unified's 2022-2026 Strategic Plan, Pillar 4 Operational Effectiveness, Modernizing Infrastructure by upgrading facilities to support the instructional program.

Budget Impact:

The proposed action does not have a budget impact as the Board previously authorized funding for the proposed Project when it adopted the project definition. The current budget for the proposed Project is \$173,355,078. The proposed Project is funded by Bond Program funds targeted in the SUP for major modernizations, upgrades, and reconfigurations to school campuses.

Student Impact:

The proposed Project will help ensure that approximately 900 existing and future students attending the school are provided with safe and updated facilities that support learning.

Equity Impact:

The intent of the major modernization project is to address buildings and grounds that pose a safety concern and have the greatest need for upgrades with emphasis placed on seismic safety, reducing Los Angeles Unified's reliance on relocatable buildings, and addressing the most critical/severe physical conditions. While

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the proposed Project is extensive in nature, less critical items may not be addressed. This approach allows Los Angeles Unified to reach more schools with the limited funding available.

Issues and Analysis:

OEHS evaluated the proposed Project to determine potential impacts on the environment in accordance with CEQA and State CEQA Guidelines. This evaluation, as documented in the Initial Study (IS), resulted in the preparation of an EIR. The EIR was circulated for a 45-day public review period from September 16, 2024, to October 31, 2024. The analysis documented in the EIR found that the proposed Project would result in significant environmental impacts as a result of construction or operation of the proposed Project. Pursuant to State CEQA Guidelines, prior to the proposed Project proceeding into construction, the Board must certify the EIR and subsequently must approve the proposed Project.

Attachments:

None

Informatives:

None

Submitted:

11/21/24

RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


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Superintendent

APPROVED BY:


PEDRO SALCIDO
Deputy Superintendent
Business Services and Operations

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED BY:


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Facilities Services Division

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NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Financial Officer☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

PRESENTED BY:


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